Encryption hit the backup vault Within 12 minutes the ransomware demanded **$2.3 million** and erased **84%** of our **immutable snapshots**. Do we negotiate, rebuild, or pivot to a server-less redesign?

▓ THE DEFENSE BRIEF The incident surfaced on **Oct 22, 2026** when our **SIEM** flagged a sudden spike in file-system writes on the primary NAS. **CISA** released an advisory (CVE-2023-38831) linking the payload to the **LockBit 3.0** family, which now accounts for **27%** of all ransomware incidents reported in Q3 2026. The ransom note quoted a **48-hour** deadline, forcing us to choose between a costly payment and a full architecture overhaul.

⚠ TECHNICAL RADIANCE What most teams assume: paying the ransom will instantly restore data and let operations resume. What actually happens: **63%** of victims who pay never receive a functional decryption key, and the average decryption time stretches to **7 days** after payment, during which critical services remain offline.

Last week our incident response squad isolated the infected segment and I manually extracted the **RSA-2048** key from the malware’s dropper. The process bought us **3 hours** to begin a controlled shutdown of the legacy VM fleet before the deadline hit.

[illegible] KEY ARCHITECTURE We are now migrating every workload to **AWS Lambda**-style serverless functions. The move promises near-zero idle cost, but the vendor lock-in risk is real: a single API change could break **95%** of our business logic. To mitigate, we are building an abstraction layer using **Terraform** modules and **OpenAPI** contracts, ensuring portability across **Azure Functions** and **Google Cloud Run**.

▓ Operational Checklist • Verify **IOC** feeds against **Passhunt** default-credential database. • Initiate **SOAR** playbook: isolate, snapshot, negotiate, rebuild. • Conduct forensic imaging of the ransomware-affected node within **30 minutes**. • Validate backup integrity: test restore of at least **3 random snapshots** weekly. • Document all **TTP** in a shared **ATT&CK** matrix for future red-team simulations.

[redacted] Poll for Change You have **1 hour** until the ransomware deadline. Do you: 1. Pay the ransom and hope for a decryption key. 2. Trigger a full cloud-native rebuild on serverless infrastructure. 3. Engage a third-party negotiator while preserving forensic evidence.

$ **ENCRYPTION HIT THE BACKUP VA

[NO GLYPH] Tool Recommendation **Passhunt** ([NO GLYPH] 1310) scans for default credentials across **523** vendors and **2,084** known defaults. In a ransomware scenario, early credential discovery can stop lateral movement before encryption spreads. Deploy it in your **CI/CD** pipeline and as a nightly **SOAR** action.

If you wait for the deadline, you’ll lose the chance to secure your data – act now or watch your backups vanish.

NOGLYPH Source: https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/cybersecurity-adv
#RansomwareResponse #DFIR #ServerlessSecurity #IncidentResponse #Passhunt